

SECURE YOUR LOAD

Driving with an unsecured load is both against the law and extremely dangerous. Secure your load so loose items don't release into the air or slide, shift, or fall onto the road and cause a crash.

To secure the load in your vehicle or trailer:

- Tie everything down with rope, netting, or straps.
- Tie large objects directly to your vehicle or trailer.
- Pack your vehicle or trailer only with items you can safely and securely carry.

ANIMALS

- It's illegal for anyone to transport an animal outside a vehicle (such as the bed of a truck) without a protective harness or enclosure, so the animal can't jump or fall out.
- It's a misdemeanor to transport animals in a way that would pose a risk to the animal or public safety, according to Washington's Prevention of Cruelty to Animals laws. If you're taken into custody for any reason, an officer can take charge of any animal(s) in the vehicle. If your animal is in police custody, you'll need to pay a fee before you can collect the animal.
- It's illegal to engage in any activity that takes your focus off safely driving your vehicle. Animals that are loose in a vehicle or riding on the driver's lap are a potential distraction.